

Proposal for Developing a Multi-Use Community Education Campus

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Professional Writing Portfolio

This internal proposal recommends that the school district develop a multi-use community education campus as part of future school construction and renovation efforts. Like the communities discussed in the assigned article, our community faces the challenge of meeting growing educational needs while also providing residents with access to healthcare, recreation, adult education, and community programs. School facilities represent a significant public investment but are often used primarily during regular school hours. By designing facilities that can serve both students and the surrounding community, the district can make better use of public resources while creating a central location for educational and community services.

As communities grow, school districts must accommodate changing enrollment, maintain aging facilities, update technology, and provide students with modern learning environments. At the same time, residents need affordable locations for recreation, healthcare services, meetings, cultural activities, and continuing education. Constructing separate facilities for each of these purposes can increase taxpayer costs and lead to duplicated resources.

The Gaylord Community School in Gaylord, Michigan, provides an example of a different approach. According to the assigned article, its campus combines a high school with senior and daycare centers, adult education classrooms, a performing arts auditorium, healthcare services, and space for community events. Similarly, the Big Lake School District in Minnesota places its elementary, middle, and high schools on a centralized campus that also includes a theater, community resource center, and multipurpose athletic arena. Both examples demonstrate how school facilities can become important centers of community activity rather than being limited to traditional classroom use.

Additional research supports this approach. Maier et al. (2017) found that community schools can improve student outcomes by integrating academic programs with health and social

services while strengthening relationships among schools, families, and community organizations. Adopting a similar approach would allow our district to address educational and community needs while maximizing the use of public facilities.

I recommend that the district incorporate a multi-use community campus model into future construction and major renovation projects. Instead of designing facilities exclusively for students during traditional school hours, selected areas should be designed for flexible use in the evenings, on weekends, and during school breaks.

The campus could include classrooms for adult education and workforce development, a community health area for preventive care and wellness programs, and meeting rooms for civic and nonprofit organizations. A performing arts auditorium could accommodate school productions and community events, while athletic and recreational facilities could serve students during the school day and residents during designated community hours. Childcare and senior programs could also be considered based on community demand.

Student safety would remain a priority. Community-accessible areas should have separate entrances where possible, and shared-use agreements should establish responsibilities for scheduling, staffing, maintenance, security, and operating expenses. This approach would allow community programs to operate without interfering with regular school activities.

The proposed campus would provide several benefits to the district and community. Students would have increased access to educational resources, health programs, technology, and other support services. Residents would gain convenient access to adult education, recreation, cultural events, and community programs without the need to construct separate facilities for each service.

Research indicates that community school strategies can improve attendance, academic achievement, family engagement, and access to essential services when they are implemented effectively (Maier et al., 2017). The U.S. Department of Education (2025) also supports Full-Service Community Schools that coordinate educational opportunities with health, social, and family services through partnerships between schools and community organizations.

The proposal could also provide greater value for taxpayers. School facilities that might otherwise be underused in the evenings, on weekends, and for portions of the year could remain active and provide services to a much larger percentage of the community. Partnerships with healthcare providers, nonprofit organizations, local businesses, and government agencies could further reduce the school district's financial burden by sharing resources and responsibilities.

The district should begin with a community needs assessment. It should survey parents, students, teachers, residents, and community organizations to determine which services are most needed. The district should also hold public meetings to gather feedback and build community support.

After identifying priorities, school officials and architects should determine how to incorporate flexible community spaces into future construction or renovations without compromising student safety. The district should then establish partnerships with healthcare providers, nonprofit organizations, local businesses, and government agencies that could provide programs, personnel, or financial support.

Funding could come from several sources, including local and state programs, community partnerships, grants, and federal opportunities. The U.S. Department of Education's Full-Service Community Schools Program supports partnerships designed to coordinate

educational and community services (U.S. Department of Education, 2025). Programs should be introduced gradually so that the district can evaluate participation, expenses, and community feedback before expanding services.

The school district has a significant opportunity to increase the long-term value of its facilities for both students and the broader community. The Gaylord and Big Lake examples demonstrate that school campuses can effectively function as shared centers for education, recreation, healthcare, cultural activities, and civic engagement. In addition, research supports the community school model as an effective strategy for strengthening student services, family engagement, and partnerships with local organizations (Maier et al., 2017). By adopting a multi-use community education campus model, the district can make more efficient use of public resources while expanding access to services that benefit residents of all ages. **Recommended Action:** The School District Executive Board should authorize an initial community needs assessment and feasibility study. This action would allow the district to evaluate demand, identify implementation requirements, and determine whether the proposed campus model is practical, financially responsible, and aligned with district and community priorities.

References

Maier, A., Daniel, J., Oakes, J., & Lam, L. (2017). *Community schools as an effective school improvement strategy: A review of the evidence*. Learning Policy Institute.

<https://learningpolicyinstitute.org/product/community-schools-effective-school-improvement-report>

U.S. Department of Education. (2025). *Full-service community schools program (FSCS)*.

<https://www.ed.gov/grants-and-programs/grants-birth-grade-12/school-and-community-improvement-grants/full-service-community-schools-program-fscs>